

Grade	1	Word Count	225
Lexile	490L	Multi-level	H K S
Learning A–Z	level H		

Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

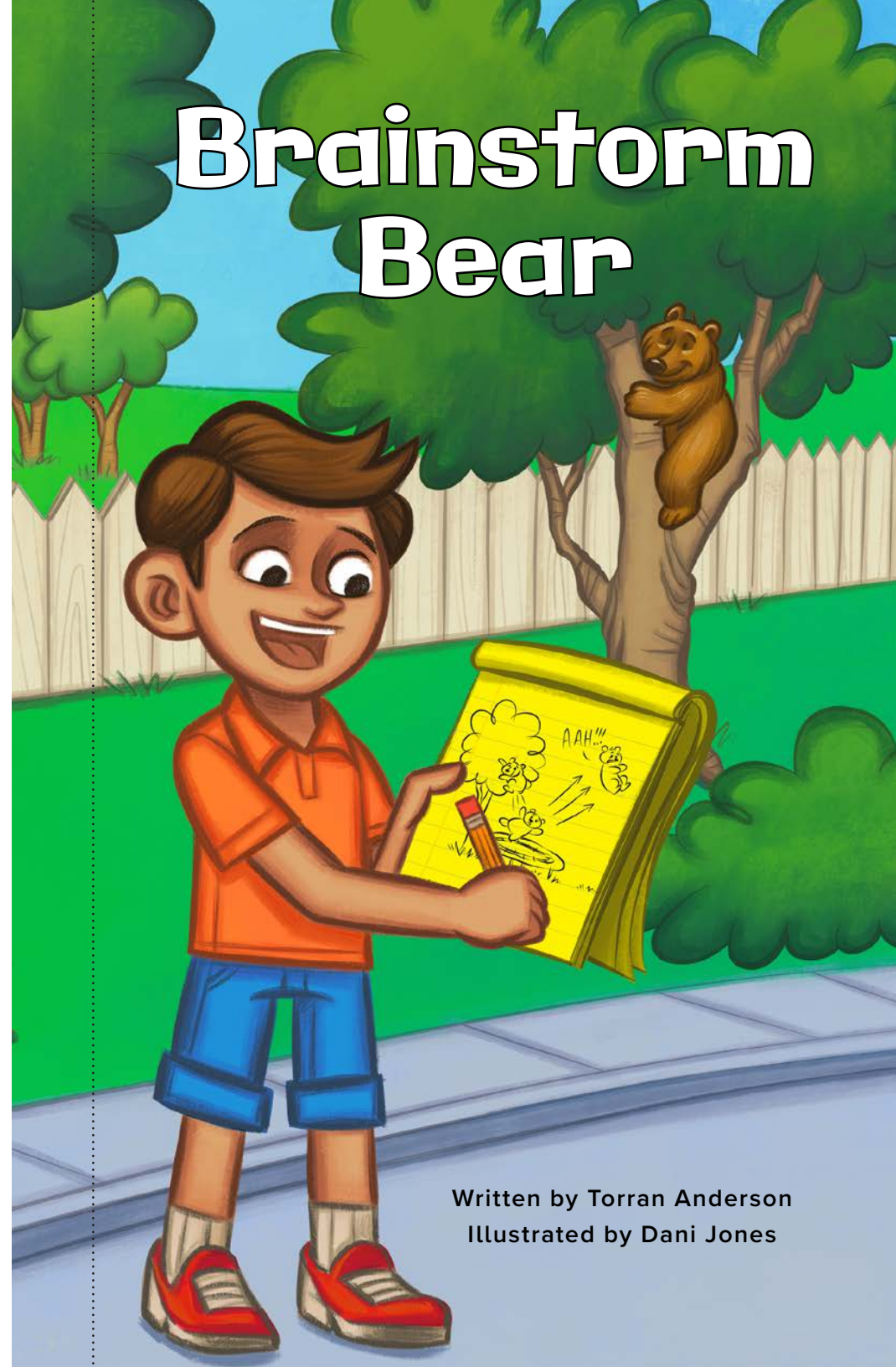
The Miller family gets a big surprise when they go outside to set up a yard sale and find a bear in a tree. How will they get it down? **Brainstorm Bear** is an entertaining and humorous story that is accompanied by cute illustrations.



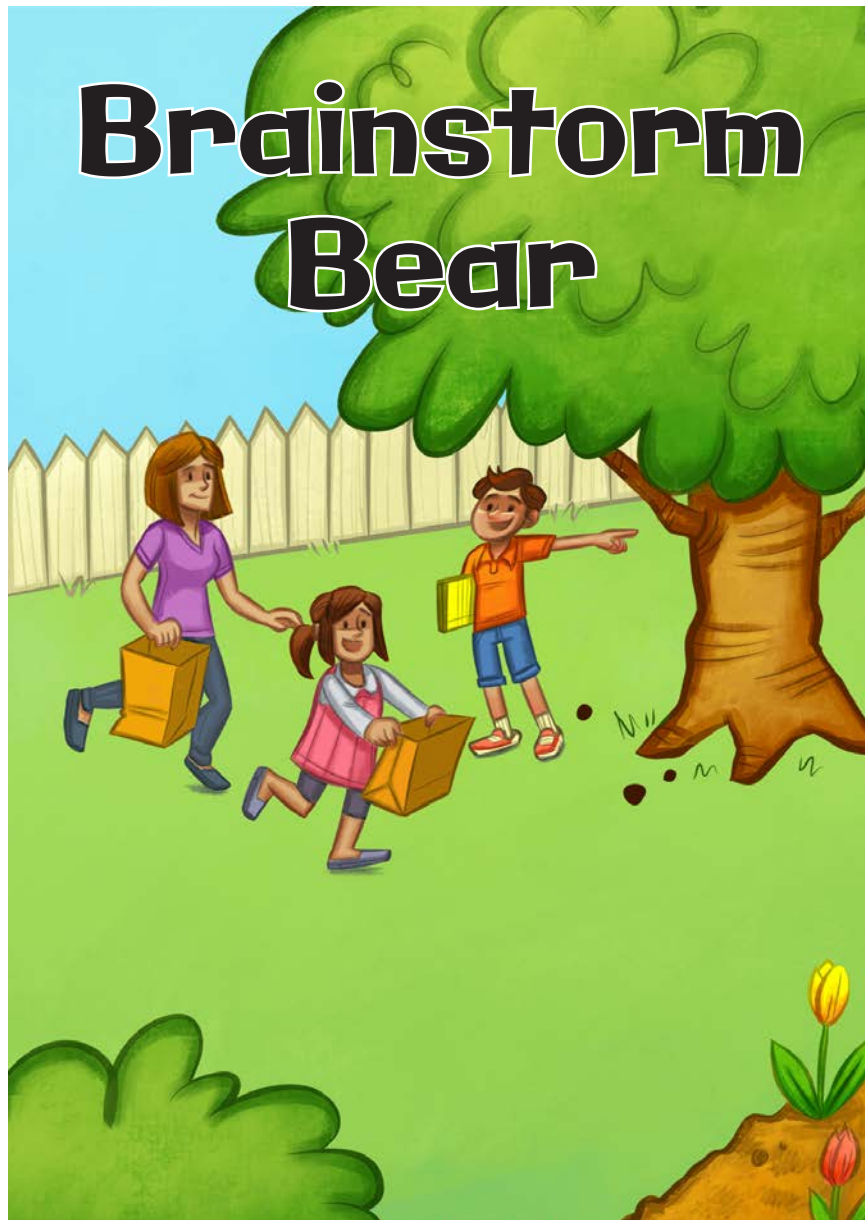
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Brainstorm Bear



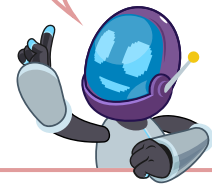
Written by Torran Anderson
Illustrated by Dani Jones



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Focus Question

Why does the family in the story brainstorm?



Words to Know

bouncing	trail
brainstorm	trampoline
idea	yard sale

Connections

Writing and Art

How would you have tried to solve the family's problem?

Draw a picture and write about it.

Science

What do you know about bears?

Share your ideas with a partner.



“Mom, there’s a bear in that tree over there!” Sam called.



“We need to get him down before our **yard sale** starts,” he said.



“We could call off the sale,”
Mrs. Miller said.
“We just need to **brainstorm** a way
to get him down,” said Sam.



“We could move our **trampoline**
under the tree,” Sam’s little sister
Sarah said.



“Draw the **idea**,” said Mrs. Miller to Sam.
Sam drew the idea on his pad of paper.



He drew the bear **bouncing** up into the air.
“I don’t think that will work,” he said.



“Mom, what would you do?”

Sarah asked.

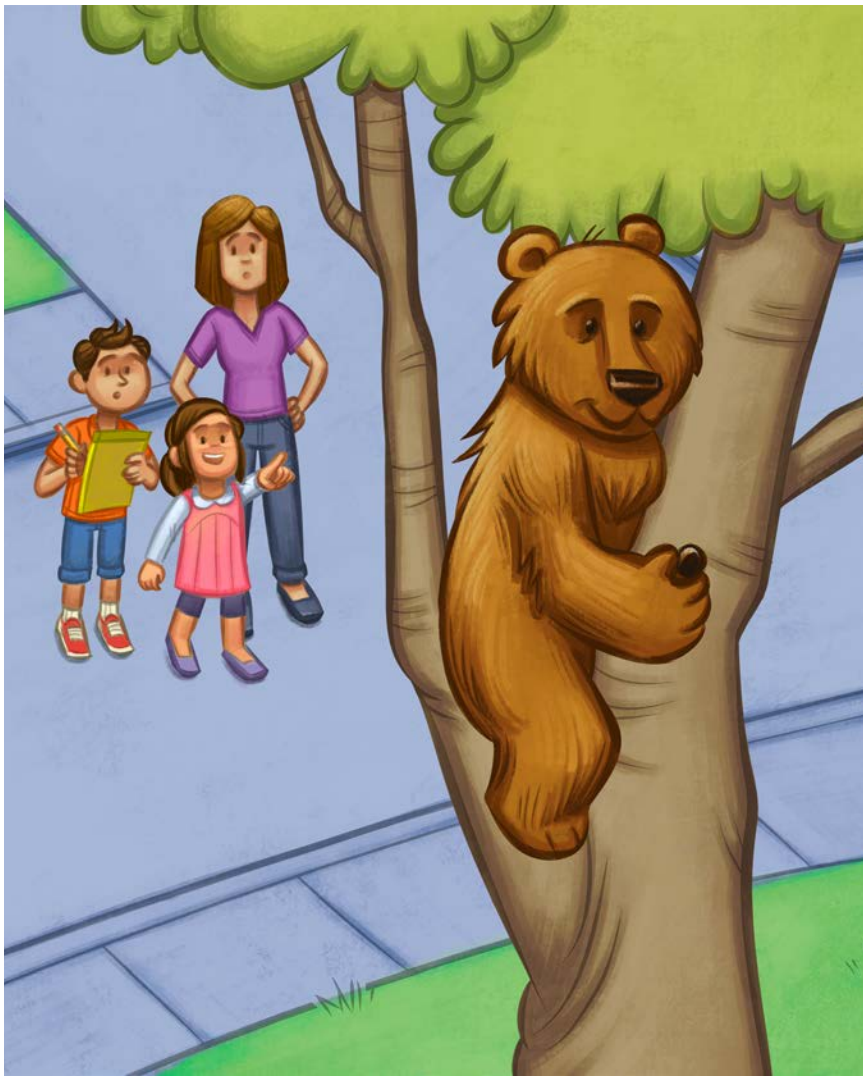
“I’d play some really bad music,”

Mrs. Miller laughed.



Sam drew the idea on his pad
of paper.

He drew the bear climbing up the
tree to get away from the noise.



“That might make things worse,”
Sam sighed.
“Look, the bear’s eating nuts
up there,” Sarah said.



“I’ve got it!” Sam shouted.
“We can make a **trail** of nuts
leading back to the forest,” he said.



“Let’s try it,” Mrs. Miller said.
Everyone went to get nuts from
under a tree in the back yard.



While they were gone, the bear
climbed down and left on its own.
“Aw, the bear is gone!” Sam said.



“Look on the bright side,”
Mrs. Miller said.
“At least you can have the yard sale
now,” she smiled.

Bear Safety

In many places, bears sometimes come close to people's homes. If you see a bear near your house, do not go near it. Back away slowly and calmly and go inside your house. Stay inside and call your local Department of Wildlife if you need help.

Glossary

bouncing (v.) page 8

moving quickly back from or springing off a surface after hitting against it

brainstorm (v.) page 5

to share and develop ideas, often related to solving a problem

idea (n.) page 7

a thought, belief, or opinion

trail (n.) page 12

a series of tracks, signs, or smells left behind when something moves from one place to another

trampoline (n.) page 6

a device for bouncing that has a strong, tightly stretched piece of fabric attached with springs to a frame

yard sale (n.) page 4

an event where used items are sold outside the seller's home